

Project Name : The path of the blind sun

Team Name : Pinaka

Team members { email / indieconnect ID }

1. srajan barkade : srajanbarkade11@gmail.com / @srajan
2. harshit pagare : hpagare62@gmail.com / @harshit_p

1. Project Overview & Theme Integration

- **Game Title:** *Path of the Blind Sun*
- **Event:** TGC Game Jam 2026
- **Genre:** Action-Adventure Platformer / Souls-like Fantasy
- **Setting:** Dark Medieval India
- **The Jam Theme Intersections:**
 - **Comic:** Every level is an active comic book page, and every screen or panel acts as a distinct narrative-driven platforming block the player must traverse.
 - **Twist:** The protagonist, Vikram, believes he is collecting shards of a divine light to save the world, only to realize his quest is a manipulation orchestrated by the final villain to harness ultimate power.
 - **Light:** Core mechanical and visual motif the divine shards illuminate the dark, oppressive environments, act as combat tools, and govern visibility and safety.

2. Narrative Premise & Lore

Set in a decaying medieval Indian fantasy realm, the story follows **Vikram**, a weary warrior of a fallen clan. Guided by cryptic ancient inscriptions found in forgotten ruins, Vikram discovers the first fragment of the **Tejas** (The Luminous Jewel).

Convinced by a false prophecy, he embarks on a cross-country pilgrimage to deliver and unite the shards at a distant hill fort to prevent a looming global calamity. Unbeknownst to him, this entire quest is a carefully engineered ploy by **Mahaketu, the Shadow Asura**, who uses Vikram's pure intent as a conduit to gather ambient soul-energy and break the cosmic seals.

Standing in Vikram's way are tragic "**Minor Bosses**" warriors who know the horrifying truth of the prophecy. Because they try to stop him by force, Vikram (and the player) views them as enemies, only to learn their true, protective intentions with their dying breaths.

3. Unique Art & Level Design Style

- **Golden Age Comic Aesthetics:** Inspired by classic, master-crafted comic storytelling, the game features dynamic panel gutters, bold ink lines and rich vintage color palettes that shift as the story darkens.
 - **Panel-to-Level Architecture:** The game space is literally structured like a comic page. Players move from panel border to panel border, where camera pans, framing, and speech bubbles double as environmental storytelling and UI elements.
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4. Core Gameplay Loop & Mechanics

- **Panel Navigation Platforming:** Movement requires navigating terrain shaped like comic panels leaping across gutters, scaling panel borders, and triggering interactive narrative blocks to progress.
 - **Souls-like Combat & Light Management:** Fast-paced, tactical melee combat utilizing traditional weapons like the *talwar* and *katar*. The divine light acts as a dynamic torch in pitch-black subterranean levels, but drawing too much power leaves Vikram vulnerable to ambient darkness and lurking *Pishacha Crawlers*.
 - **Progression Structure:** An 18-stage journey split into distinct comic-page levels, featuring environmental puzzles and high-stakes cinematic boss duels.
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5. Target Impact for TGC Game Jam 2026

- **Innovative Fusion:** Seamlessly marries the interactive pacing of an action platformer with the visual grammar of a comic book.
- **Narrative Depth:** Delivers a poignant, twist-driven tragedy within a rich medieval Indian mythological framework.
- **Cohesive Theme Delivery:** Explores the triad of *Comic*, *Twist*, and *Light* not just as checklist constraints, but as the foundational pillars of the game's mechanics, art direction, and story.